

Residence Life Tommie Advantage 2025 - 2026

FY & SY Roommate Agreement & Conflict Resolution Process Lesson Plan (2.a, 2.d, 3.b)

Scheduled, Required Roommate Agreement Steps:

- **Part 1 – Introduction to Process via CD/GSA Email:**
 - Timeline: Sent by CD/GSA: no later than August 10, 2025
 - Notes:
 - Included in FY & SY Community Communication #1 (separate lesson plan)
 - Roommates encouraged to begin discussing, not required to submit anywhere
- **Part 2 – Initial Roommate Agreements:**
 - Timelines:
 - FY:
 - Guidance included in FY Community Meeting #1 on Wed., August 27, 2025 (separate lesson plan)
 - Instructions sent out via Roompack email on Thur., August 28, 2025
 - Due: Monday, September 1, 2025
 - SY:
 - Guidance included in SY Community Meeting #1 on Tues., September 2, 2025 (separate lesson plan)
 - Instructions sent out via Roompack email on Wed., September 3, 2025
 - Due: Sunday, September 7, 2025
 - Notes:
 - Roommates complete Roompack Roommate Agreement (together)
 - Roommates sign agreement on Roompack
 - Could incentivize completion with a giveaway (CD/GSA determines & uses own budget for prizes)
- **Part 3 – RA Check In via Touch Base Meeting:**
 - Timeline:
 - Begins: September 3, 2025
 - Due: September 21, 2025
 - Notes:
 - Included in FY & SY Touch Base #1 (separate lesson plan)
 - No action required by residents outside of Touch Base conversation
- **Part 4 – Roompack Microsurvey Check In:**
 - Timeline:
 - Sent: Wednesday, September 24, 2025
 - Due: Friday, September 26, 2025
 - Follow Ups (Embedded in prioritized 1:1 Conversations):
 - Red (“Bad”) Due: Sunday, October 5, 2025
 - Yellow (“Okay”) Due: Sunday, October 12, 2025
 - Notes:
 - Microsurvey texted via Roompack with options (good, okay, bad)
 - Residents respond via text with their selected option
 - CD/GSAs and RAs follow up on yellow and red rooms
 - CD/GSAs and RAs submit Roommate Conflict Tracking Form via Roompack (<https://roompack.com/forms/#/form/xvqpl0>)

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- **Part 5 – RA Check In via 1:1 Conversation:**
 - Timeline:
 - Begins: September 29, 2025
 - Due: November 9, 2025
 - Notes:
 - Included in FY & SY 1:1 Conversation #1 (separate lesson plan)
 - RAs will prioritize scheduling 1:1s with residents who responded to the Microsurvey with “Bad” and “Okay”
 - No action required by residents outside of 1:1 conversation
- **Part 6 – Revisit Agreement:**
 - Timeline:
 - Sent: Tuesday, October 14, 2025
 - Due: Sunday, October 19, 2025
 - Notes:
 - Instructions to revisit agreement sent out via email
 - Roommates revisit and suggest revisions the agreement (together)
 - Roommates sign agreement on Roompack
 - CD/GSAs can view the agreements by completion date to determine if agreements have been updated – can incentivize if desired
- **Part 7 – Initial Roommate Agreements (New Spring Residents & Roommates):**
 - Timeline:
 - Sent: Wednesday, February 4, 2026
 - Due: Sunday, February 8, 2026
 - Notes:
 - Instructions to revisit agreement sent out via email
 - Roommates revisit and suggest revisions the agreement (together)
 - Roommates sign agreement on Roompack
 - CD/GSAs can view the agreements by completion date to determine if agreements have been updated – can incentivize if desired
- **Part 8 – Revisit Agreement (Spring Returning Residents & Roommates):**
 - Timeline:
 - Sent: Wednesday, February 4, 2026
 - Due: Sunday, February 8, 2026
 - Notes:
 - Instructions to revisit agreement sent out via email
 - Roommates revisit and suggest revisions the agreement (together)
 - Roommates sign agreement on Roompack
 - CD/GSAs can view the agreements by completion date to determine if agreements have been updated – can incentivize if desired

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As Needed Conflict Resolution Steps (RA Lead):

Note: though not always sequential, RA intervention is intended to occur prior to CD/GSA intervention; if residents have not worked with their RA, they may be directed to start there.

- **RA Individual Support Meeting:**

- Timeline:
 - Happens as needed based on:
 - Student request
 - Yellow or Red room on Roompack
 - Information learned from 1:1s
 - CARE referral
- Notes:
 - Appropriate when a resident:
 - Could benefit from some potential strategy exploration
 - Could benefit from some basic skill building
 - RA facilitates with lesson plan
 - Submits Roommate Conflict Tracking Form via Roompack (<https://roompack.com/forms/#/form/xvqpl0>)

- **RA Facilitated Meeting:**

- Timeline:
 - Happens as needed based on:
 - Student request
 - Yellow or Red room on Roompack
 - Information learned from 1:1s
 - Resident request
 - CARE referral
- Notes:
 - Appropriate when:
 - Roommates are struggling with completing initial Roompack Roommate Agreement or with a revision
 - A conversation among roommates would benefit from a multipartial facilitator
 - Currently held positions require exploration of additional solutions to address needs
 - RA facilitates with lesson plan
 - Should wrap up with a completed or fully revised Roompack Roommate Agreement
 - Submits Roommate Conflict Tracking Form via Roompack (<https://roompack.com/forms/#/form/xvqpl0>)

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As Needed Conflict Resolution Steps (CD/GSA Lead):

- **CD/GSA Individual Coaching:**
 - Timeline:
 - Intended to happen **after** RA Individual Support and RA Facilitated Meeting
 - May happen before or after CD/GSA Roommate Mediation
 - Ongoing as needed
 - Notes:
 - CD/GSA facilitates with lesson plan and conflict coaching skills
 - CD/GSA submits Roommate Conflict Tracking Form via Roompack (<https://roompack.com/forms/#/form/xvqpl0>)
- **CD/GSA Roommate Mediation:**
 - Timeline:
 - Intended to happen **after** RA Individual Support and RA Facilitated Meeting
 - May happen before or after CD/GSA Individual Coaching
 - Ongoing as needed
 - Notes:
 - CD/GSA facilitates with lesson plan and conflict coaching skills
 - Potentially Includes:
 - CD/GSA recommending specific solutions
 - Required adjustments to Roompack Roommate Agreement
 - Behavior contracts with detailed follow-up plan
 - Room change (serious conduct or safety concerns **only**, requires approval from Associate Director and Director of Residence Life)
 - CD/GSA submits Roommate Conflict Tracking Form via Roompack (<https://roompack.com/forms/#/form/xvqpl0>)

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Facilitation Guide - RA Individual Support Meeting:

Facilitator: RA

Timelines:

- FY & SY:
 - Happens as needed based on:
 - Student request
 - Yellow or Red room on Roompack
 - Information learned from 1:1s
 - CARE referral
- Notes:
 - Appropriate when a resident:
 - Could benefit from some potential strategy exploration
 - Could benefit from some basic skill building
 - RA facilitates with lesson plan
 - Submits Roommate Conflict Tracking Form via Roompack (<https://roompack.com/forms/#/form/xvqpl0>)

Duration: 20 – 30 minutes

Preparation:

- Review lesson plan
- Review Conflict Resolution Guide
- Feel comfortable with the strategies so you can facilitate as needed

Concepts to keep in mind when residents approach RAs about a roommate concern:

- This is a new experience for many residents and our role is to help them through it
- Conflict affects our whole bodies – centering and calming our nervous systems helps us to better manage next steps
- We all have a filter of our lived experiences and identities and these impact how we communicate and receive communication
- Most of the population is conflict avoidant, but we cannot avoid our roommates

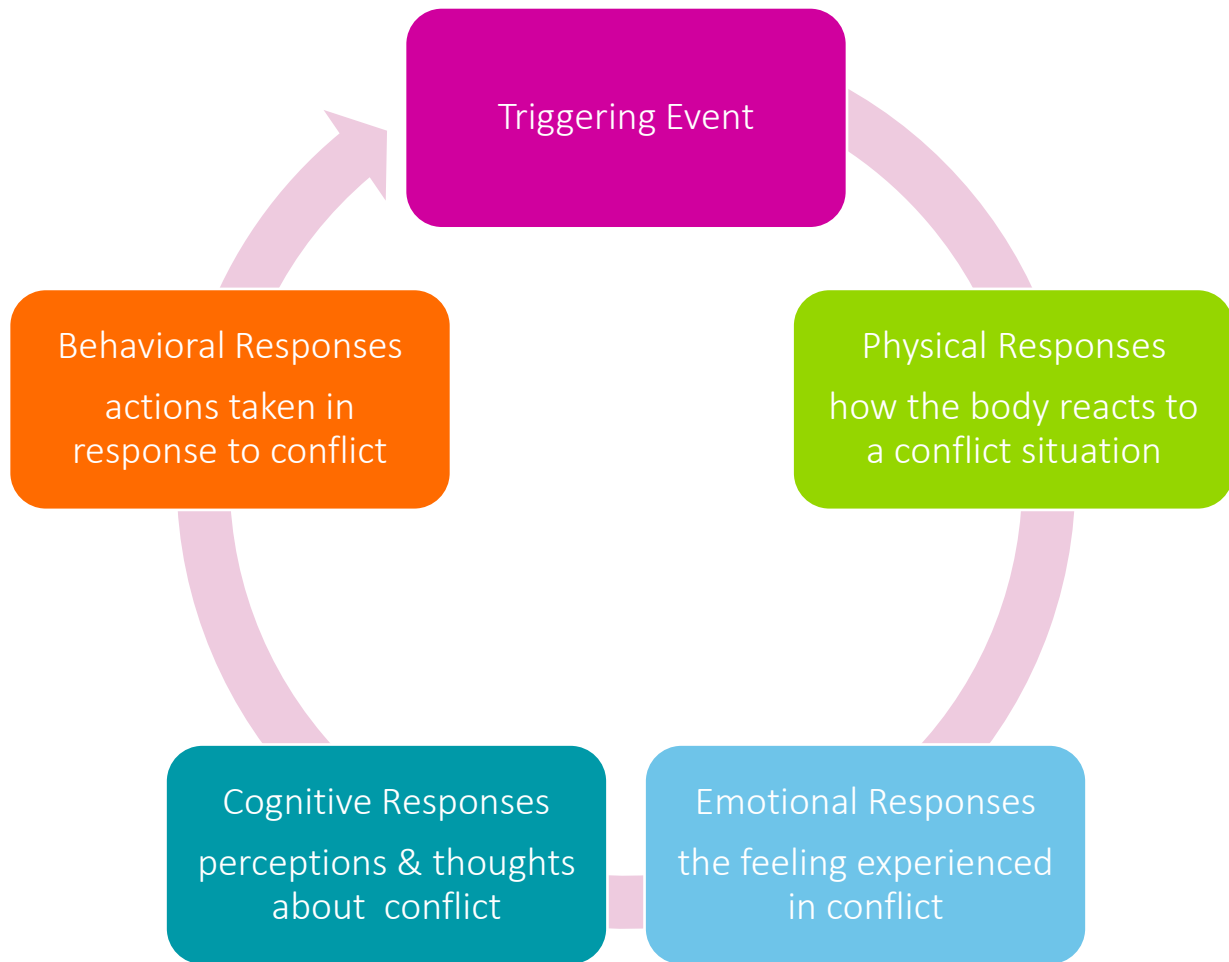
Materials Needed:

- Lesson Plan
- Resources & Conflict Resolution Guide
- Way to take notes

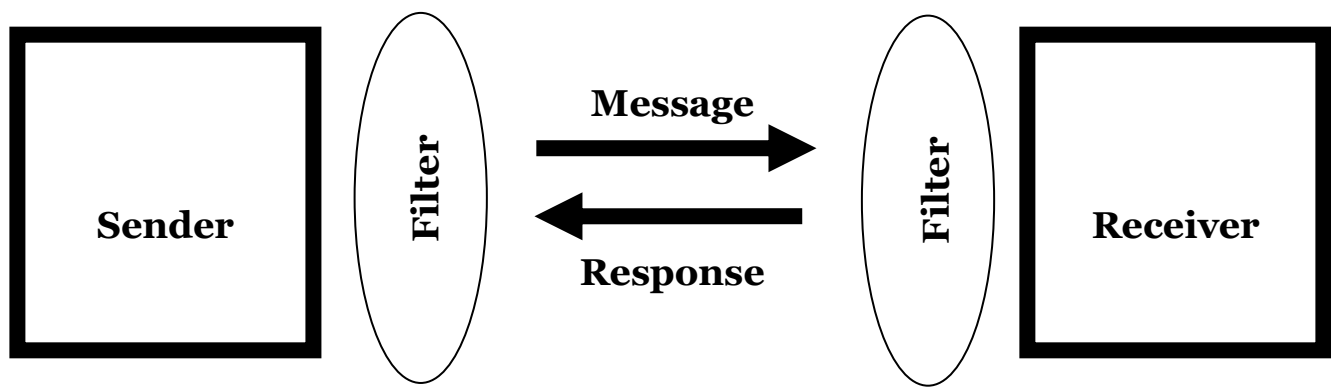
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Conflict: A Whole Body Experience



Communication



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Conflict Resolution Guide

UNIVERSITY OF St. Thomas.

CONFLICT RESOLUTION GUIDE

EXPERIENCING CONFLICT?

Not sure how to resolve it?

This is your quick Guide to Conflict Resolution.

For more information, contact:
Dean of Students Office
 (651) 962-6050
deanofstudents@stthomas.edu

HOW TO RESOLVE CONFLICTS PEACEFULLY

- Treat people with cultural humility, dignity, respect diversity, practice empathy, and allow people to "save face".
- Seek first to understand. Then to be understood.
- Use the CLARA Method of Communication: Center, Listen, Affirm, Respond, Add.
- Use "I Statements" to share how you feel and why. State your needs and how you would like the future to be different.
- Approach conflicts as a path to inclusive excellence and an opportunity to resolve problems.

NON-VIOLENT COMMUNICATION PROCESS

Developed by Dr. Marshall Rosenberg

OBSERVATION "I noticed..."
 State objective, unbiased facts.
 NOT: "The kitchen is a mess."
 TRY: "I saw dishes in the sink."

FEELINGS "I feel..."
 Culture influences how feelings are expressed. Allow people to express their feelings in a variety of ways, focus on connection and resolution.

NEEDS "I need..."
 Share the meaning of your human needs and how it is expressed in your culture/family: "In my community/culture respect means..."

REQUESTS "Can we...?"
 Ask for what will help to fix the conflict and reconcile issues, co-create ideas, etc.
 Can we make a schedule?"

Ex: "I noticed you left the lights on after 11 pm. I felt restless because I can't sleep with the lights on. I need rest to perform well in class. Can we agree on a lights-out schedule?"

FEELINGS

When in conflict, we tend to blame and judge others, causing discord. Opening up and sharing feelings creates connection and resolution.

PRIMARY	SPECIFIC
ANGRY	Enraged, Furious, Resentful, Outraged
UPSET	Agitated, Restless, Overwhelmed
AFRAID	Anxious, Concerned, Worried, Wary
CONFUSED	Ambivalent, Lost, Hesitant, Puzzled
SAD	Disappointed, Unhappy, Weary
CONTENT	Satisfied, Glad, Fulfilled, Cheerful

LISTENING AND RESPONDING

CLARA is a useful framework for responding to questions and verbal attacks.

C **CLARIFY** yourself internally so that you can honestly be engaged in listening.

L **LISTEN** to understand the other person's feelings and universal human needs.

A **AFFIRM** to show you heard them, acknowledge something they said, or affirm their humanity. You do not need to agree with them.

R **RESPOND** to the issue the person raised. If you agree, say that.

A **ADD** by sharing additional information. Try to find a connection and common ground.

CONFLICT RESOLUTION

- CONSULTATION
- CONFLICT RESOLUTION SERVICES

Dean of Students Office
 (651) 962-6050
deanofstudents@stthomas.edu

CONFLICT STYLES

There are 5 conflict styles. Each is a function of how we focus on our personal agenda and our relationships. There is no best style.

1	2	3	4	5
COMPETITOR We're doing it my way, period. I win, you lose.	COLLABORATOR How can we both get what we want? I win, you win.	COMPROMISER Let's split the difference and meet half way. I win and lose some, you win and lose some.	AVOIDER Just forget about it. I'm fine. I lose, you lose.	ACCOMMODATOR Whatever you want. You win, I lose.

← LESS Focus on Personal Agenda MORE →

← LESS Focus on Relationships MORE →

INTERCULTURAL CONFLICT STYLE

1 DISCUSSION STYLE	2 ENGAGEMENT STYLE	3 ACCOMMODATION STYLE	4 DYNAMIC STYLE
- Confronts problems - Elaborates position or argument - Maintains a calm atmosphere	- Provides detailed explanations, information, instructions - Freely expresses opinions - Shows feelings	- Considers alternative meanings to ambiguous messages - Able to control emotional outbursts - Sensitive to the feelings of the other party	- Uses "third parties" to gather information and resolve difficulties - Skilled at observing changes in non-verbal behavior - Comfortable with strong emotional displays

DIRECT

INDIRECT

EMOTIONAL RESTRAINT

EMOTIONAL EXPRESSIVENESS

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Lesson Plan Outline:

- Welcome the resident to the conversation and ask what is going on
- Use the CLARA method to begin the conversation:
 - Quick Reference:
 - Calming and Centering
 - Listening
 - Affirming
 - Responding
 - Adding
 - Calming and Centering
 - Let the student know that roommate situations can be difficult and that sometimes it helps to take a deep breath together to talk through things
 - Use other mindfulness strategies as appropriate
 - Listening
 - Ask what is happening for the resident
 - Listen without judgement or jumping in with solutions
 - Affirming
 - Affirm the resident's feelings and concerns (even if you disagree)
 - Phrases like "it sounds like this is difficult for you" can help show you understand even if this is not a concern you would have
 - Responding
 - Summarize what you heard from the resident
 - Try to identify key points and information (what are the things causing the most concern or difficulty)
 - Ask if your summary is accurate
 - Adding
 - As you begin to contribute to the conversation, you can invite the resident again to calm and center themselves
 - Offer strategies the resident could use to address the conflict, including:
 - Share their concerns with their roommate
 - Ask the roommate to change their behavior or find a compromise
 - Brainstorm potential solutions to the concern
 - Develop a plan
 - Revisit the Roommate Agreement & document the new change
- **Room changes are not an option**, so we sympathize with how difficult this is for the resident, but let them know that learning how to work through this together is the only option to improve things and these are helpful skills to learn!
- Before considering a Facilitated Roommate Meeting, the resident needs to try to have the conversation on their own 😊

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Assessment Strategy:

- Student Learning: NA
- Follow Up Tracking:
 - RAs complete Roommate Conflict Form in Roompack (<https://roompack.com/forms/#/form/xvqpl0>)
 - RAs complete Ongoing Resident Note or Advocate FYI as needed
- Evaluation: NA

Supervision Expectations:

- Ensure RA completion of Roommate Conflict Form within 24 hours
- Ensure RA completion of Ongoing Resident Note or Advocate FYI as needed within 24 hours
- May need to refer to CARE
- Support RAs in building resident skills

Facilitation Guide - RA Facilitated Roommate Meeting:

Facilitator: RA

Timeline:

- FY & SY:
 - Happens as needed based on:
 - Student request
 - Yellow or Red room on Roompack
 - Information learned from 1:1s
 - CARE referral
- Notes:
 - Appropriate when:
 - Roommates are struggling with completing initial Roompack Roommate Agreement or with a revision
 - A conversation among roommates would benefit from a multipartial facilitator
 - Currently held positions require exploration of additional solutions to address needs
 - RA facilitates with lesson plan
 - Should wrap up with a completed or fully revised Roompack Roommate Agreement
 - Submits Roommate Conflict Tracking Form via Roompack (<https://roompack.com/forms/#/form/xvqpl0>)

Duration: 45 – 60 minutes

Preparation:

- Review Roommate Agreement
- Review lesson plan
- Review Conflict Resolution Guide
- Review all Roommate Conflict Tracking submissions

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Materials Needed:

- Lesson Plan
- Way to take notes
- Roommate Agreement (print completed or blank copies)
- Talking piece

Outline:

- Introduction & Welcome
 - Introduce yourself to the residents and share your pronouns
 - Thank the residents for taking the time to meet with you
 - “We are here today to do a roommate mediation. The goal is for you all to identify and agree on expectations for your behaviors and living space. We will also discuss strategies to address future concerns.”
 - Begin with a question or strategy to engage the group or get to know them. This could be as simple as asking the group what their favorite part of the semester is so far or their favorite thing about St. Thomas
 - Introduce the concept of the talking piece and when you might use it
 - Set up any ground rules for your time together (some examples):
 - Only one person speaks at a time
 - Actively listen (not just wait to talk)
 - Come ready to collaborate & identify solutions, not be right / “win”
 - Facilitator will be multipartial (invested in all parties) unless disagreement involves a policy violation
- Roommate Agreement Plan (if not completed in Roompack):
 - Distribute blank roommate agreements for review
 - Offer time for residents to think about their personal answers
 - Please have one resident log on to their Roompack account and serve as a note taker.
 - Line by line, go through each question or prompt with residents.
 - During each line check in to see if everyone in the room/suite/apartment agrees to what the note taker has written before moving on.
 - Have each resident answer each question accordingly.
 - Some are open-ended, some are multiple choice.
 - Some prompts will ask for clarification of previous questions. If none are needed, you may skip that prompt.
 - If there is a disagreement, engage the residents in a conversation.
 - Invite them to listen to each other and proceed with respect.
 - Ask them each to share either ideas and perspectives.
 - Find ways to compromise or find alternative solutions.
 - Remember not to take sides and validate each concern.
 - Document the expectations within the Roommate Agreement Plan.
 - After all questions and prompts are complete, each resident will be asked to “sign” the roommate agreement. They can do this on their individual computers/devices.

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- Facilitated Conversation (if Roommate Agreement was completed, but concerns persist)
 - Ask residents to think about their biggest 1 – 2 concerns
 - Remind everyone of the ground rules
 - Using circle process & a talking piece
 - Ask each resident to share their concern(s)
 - Take notes on each of the concerns
 - Repeat the concerns back to make sure you captured them correctly
 - Allow for clarifying questions (Note: not a time to be defensive, attack, etc. – only allow for questions)
 - Ask each resident to spend a few moments brainstorming solutions to the concerns on the list
 - Ask each resident to share their solutions
 - Student leader may share additional solutions as appropriate
 - Open for discussion on which solutions will work best, reminding them that they agreed to compromise
 - Once solutions / agreements have been reached, write out the exact notes
 - Make sure the residents have a copy and that you record the notes in Roomcompact on the Roommate Conflict Form
 - Set up a time to check back in (approximately 1 week later)

Assessment Strategy:

- Student Learning: NA
- Follow Up Tracking:
 - RAs complete Roommate Conflict Forms within 24 hours (<https://roomcompact.com/forms/#/form/xvqpl0>)
 - RAs complete Ongoing Resident Note or Advocate FYI as needed within 24 hours
 - RAs ensure Roommate Agreement Form is updated by residents
- Additional Use:
 - Reference for roommate conflicts / mediations / future agreement parts
 - Reference for CARE concerns
- Evaluation: NA

Supervision Expectations:

- Before Facilitated Roommate Meeting:
 - Spend time talking through entire outline, step by step
 - Prepare RAs to facilitate a circle
 - Give RAs time to practice circle facilitation
 - Discuss potential “sticky” points / challenges and potential strategies to address
 - Ensure RAs feel prepared to facilitate
- During / After Facilitated Roommate Meeting:
 - Ensure RA completion of Roommate Conflict Form (<https://roomcompact.com/forms/#/form/xvqpl0>)
 - Ensure RA completion of Ongoing Resident Note or Advocate FYI
 - Check in with RA on overall meeting
 - Review their facilitation (what went well, what would they do differently next time)
 - Discuss a follow up plan

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Notes: